

FUTURE SKILLS SERIES

AI Literacy • Lesson 5 of 6

THE TASK BOARD LESSON

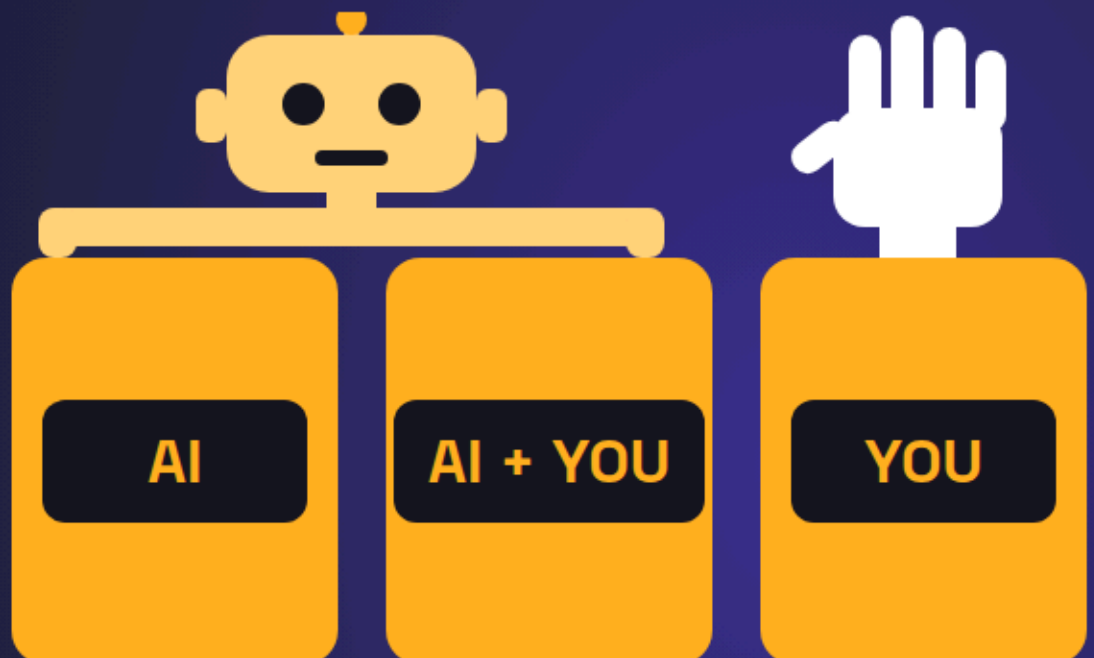
Robots Do the Boring Work

AI takes **tasks** first, not whole jobs.

Grades 6–8

45-min lesson

No prep • No devices needed



STUDENT SESSION

The Studio Task Board



Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

You're on the crew at **Big Dream Studio** — a small recording studio. **Nia** owns the place and coaches the artists. **Ravi** runs the mixing boards. **Jaylen** runs the front desk. There's too much to do, so the crew just got an AI assistant. Your job: decide what it does — and what it never touches. Every decision (grown-ups say "a call") helps someone and costs someone.

- **AUTOMATE** — boring and repeating. No decisions to make. Hand it to AI.
- **AUGMENT** — a human makes the call, AI helps out.
- **KEEP HUMAN** — coaching, taste, being there for someone. The person is the whole point.

THIS WEEK AT BIG DREAM STUDIO

- A. Send the "don't forget your session" texts to this week's artists (*Jaylen*)
- B. Rename and back up 300 audio files from last night (*Ravi*)
- C. Write the first draft of this week's social media captions (*Jaylen*)
- D. Mix a rough first version of a new artist's song (*Ravi*)
- E. Coach a nervous first-time singer through her first recording (*Nia*)
- F. Politely remind three people who still haven't paid the studio (*Jaylen*)
- G. Pick which of an artist's five new songs to release first (*Nia*)
- H. Set up the microphone for a live band and fix the echo (*Ravi*)
- I. Agree on a price with a group that wants the studio for three days (*Nia*)
- J. Type up the lyrics from yesterday's made-up-on-the-spot rap session (*Ravi*)
- K. Answer the same five questions everyone emails (price, hours, parking) (*Jaylen*)
- L. Plan the song order and mood for the big show night (*Nia*)

SORT THE BOARD

Write each task's letter in the column where it belongs — as many letters as belong there. **Every column needs at least two.** Disagree with your partner? Good — talk it out. That's the lesson.

AUTOMATE — HAND IT TO AI

AUGMENT — AI HELPS OUT

KEEP HUMAN — HUMANS ONLY

THE TASK BOARD LESSON • LESSON 5 OF 6

Robots Do the Boring Work



A 45-minute AI-and-future-jobs lesson: your class runs a busy recording studio, decides which tasks go to AI, which get AI's help, and which stay human — and owns the tradeoff behind each choice. Stands alone.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Studio Task Board worksheet (2 pages, 1 per student; fillable PDF copy included) • Slides (optional; script and keys in the notes) • board + marker for the three columns • Defense Rubric (Teacher Guide p.3) • pens	None — fully unplugged. Optional: a projector for the slides	Print worksheets. That's it.

OBJECTIVES & STANDARDS

- Sort real job tasks into **automate** / **augment** / **keep human** and explain the difference. (Sort the Board; Exit Ticket)
- Compare the tradeoffs of an automation choice — who wins, who loses something, what could go wrong. (Trade Cards; Exit Ticket AUTOMATE line)
- Defend a sorting decision aloud: a clear claim, a specific detail, eyes up, voice to the back. (Defend It — listener strip + Defense Rubric)

CSTA SC-20

CCSS ELA SL.6.4

ISTE 1.3.d

WARM-UP — THE MOST BORING JOB EVER (7 MIN)

Ask: "What's the most boring job you can think of?" Board 4–5 answers, then push on two or three of them:

"Is it boring because it **REPEATS** — same thing, over and over, no decisions? Or is it 'boring' but secretly full of people stuff — helping, noticing, warning someone down?" Sort them as a class: repeats → give it to a robot; people stuff → keep it human. (A cafeteria cashier's job repeats — but the cashier also knows which kid forgot lunch money. Let them argue; the arguing is the point.)

Bridge: Here's the honest version, no robot apocalypse: nobody can promise which jobs change, or how many. So far, it's the boring, repeating parts that get automated — AI takes over tasks, not whole jobs, and nobody can promise the final count. But every time a business automates something, somebody wins, somebody loses something, and something could go wrong. Today YOU make those decisions — for a recording studio."

What if nobody names a people-stuff job? Offer one: "Bus driver — repeats the route, but notices who's crying in row six."

Transition: "So how do you decide what a robot should take? Three columns. Eyes on the board."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION — THREE COLUMNS, ONE QUESTION (10 MIN)

Draw three columns on the board (slide 4 if projecting) and define them. Say it out loud once: a "call" is a decision.

AUTOMATE — boring and repeating. No decisions to make. Hand it to AI.

AUGMENT — a human makes the call, AI helps out.

KEEP HUMAN — coaching, taste, being there for someone. The person is the whole point.

WHEN IT GOES SIDEWAYS

A pair puts ten letters in AUTOMATE → "Which two would you hate to lose a person on?" The rule (two per column) does the rest; make them defend the two.

"Nobody loses" on a trade card → Hand them the model: even Jaylen lost something. "Who used to do this task? What did they get from it?"

A Speaker reads to the desk → Don't score it. "Eyes on us, one more time." The second try counts — and tell the Listeners to check the second try. **Odd number of pairs** → one trio of pairs rotates; sample that group. Trio: 20 seconds each, listeners mark the boxes only.

A student is upset — a parent's job is on the board → Don't predict. "Some parts of that job may change; the parts that need a person are the parts your parent is good at. Which parts are those?" Then move the class on; follow up privately if needed.

DEFENSE RUBRIC — DEFEND THE BOARD (SL.6.4)

- **Proficient:** one clear claim, a specific detail from the task, names who wins AND who loses something or what breaks; eyes up, audible at the back wall — the listener strip shows three checks.
- **Developing:** claim plus a reason, but the trade is missing or vague ("it's just faster"); one or two checks.
- **Beginning:** restates the column with no because, or reads to the desk.

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **CSTA 2-IC-20** — Compare tradeoffs associated with computing technologies that affect people's everyday activities and career options. *Taught: Direct instruction, the tradeoff lens modeled on the reminder texts. Assessed: Trade Cards (worksheet p. 2 — who wins, who loses something, what could go wrong) and the Exit Ticket AUTOMATE line, which names who loses something when a real job's task is automated.*
- **CCSS ELA SL.6.4** — Present claims and findings, sequencing ideas logically and using pertinent descriptions, facts, and details to accentuate main ideas or themes; use appropriate eye contact, adequate volume, and clear pronunciation. *Taught: the three delivery moves and the claim frame in the Defend It Strip. Assessed: Defend It — each student's claim is scored on the listener strip (eyes / voice / pace + keep / fix) by their Listener, 30 seconds each; you sample 3–4 pairs with the Defense Rubric.*
- **ISTE 1.3.d** — Students build knowledge by actively exploring real-world issues and problems, developing ideas and theories and pursuing answers and solutions. *Taught: The Studio Task Board sort (real tasks, real business). Assessed: the Exit Ticket, applying the three columns to a real job in the student's life.*

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